



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Laramie Christian Academy
School Website: <https://laramiechristianacademy.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Laramie Christian Academy (Wy 82072) presents itself publicly as a Classical Christian school with a clearly religiously framed mission and a commitment to formation alongside academics. The school positions itself as a private, classical Christian institution offering a Biblical worldview and values-driven education, with explicit emphasis on partnering with families and serving students from preschool through eighth grade (with plans to add in-seat high school). Public materials repeatedly highlight a faith-centered framework, parental partnership, and a classical orientation (including liberal arts language such as grammar, logic, rhetoric; K-8 Latin offerings; and formation-focused rhetoric around virtue and wisdom). The evidence indicates a robust theological grounding and a family-centered community, but the explicit articulation of core classical pedagogy—especially in terms of Socratic or scholé-based methods and the formal Great Books / Great Conversation program—appears less explicit on the site itself.

Overall classification: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**.

Rationale in brief: - Strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are clearly stated (Biblical worldview, Jesus-centered language, theology-integrated aims) and reinforced by parental partnership grounded in biblical commands. This anchors the school firmly in a theological frame. **CLASSICAL**. - School Purpose and Goal show formation-oriented language through Biblical knowledge and values, but explicit articulation of virtue/wisdom formation as classical telos is less overt in public copy; still aligns with formation aims. **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**. - Curriculum includes classical elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Latin in K–8; private classical Christian framing) but lacks consistent public reference to Great Books or a fully explicit Great Conversation program. **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**. - Pedagogy is not openly cataloged as Socratic/seminar-based or scholé/restful pedagogy in the public materials; other icons of classical pedagogy are not clearly stated. **NOT CLASSICAL**. - Faculty notes and leadership appear as model teachers in a traditional sense, with a focus on virtue and living curriculum, contributing **CLASSICAL** elements. - Parents & Community are clearly central and explicitly framed as co-educators with strong, tangible programs (Inside Parents, open visits, and family-centric events), contributing **CLASSICAL** elements.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public statements describe LCA as a Classical Christian school with a Biblical Worldview and a mission rooted in biblical knowledge and values, aiming to impact the world for the glory of God. This appears in the school's mission/identity statements and descriptive copy. - The mission emphasizes Jesus Christ and resilient hope, signaling transcendental moral framing and theological integration across disciplines. - The site explicitly frames education within a Biblical mandate for parental partnership and Christian formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: biblical knowledge, values; theology; Biblical worldview; faith-based language; truth/beauty/goodness alignments via “true, good, and beautiful” phrasing in contextual material. - Negative keywords: not evident in public materials (no explicit secular or relativistic framing appears). Evidence of a strongly theological frame dominates.

Why this rating - The materials foreground transcendental moral realism via biblical/theological framing and a liturgical-leaning communal ethos (though explicit liturgical practices are not extensively documented in public copy). The combination supports CLASSICAL in spirit, but the presence of the category’s elements is not as fully explicit as the strongest classical lexicon would require (e.g., liturgical calendars, explicit transcendental realism language, or written affirmations of truth/beauty as real, knowable ideals). The balance of strong theological grounding with formation language justifies SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes “academic excellence,” “biblical knowledge and values,” and “a resilient hope in Jesus Christ,” signaling formation toward virtue and wisdom rather than purely vocational preparation. - Public copy emphasizes formation in a Biblical framework rather than a sole emphasis on career readiness, aligning with classical aims of formation and virtue through faith. - The presence of a growing high school pathway and the classical framing suggests telos oriented toward formation with a long-view of education beyond information transfer.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation (implied through “development” of virtue and biblical formation terms); virtue/wisdom language appears conceptually through Biblical knowledge and values (though not always spelled out as “virtue” or “wisdom” in copy); academic excellence; Biblical worldview. - Negative keywords: not apparent (no explicit callout of workforce-first or career-prep framing; the site emphasizes formation-over-work in its stated aims).

Why this rating - The school clearly centers education as formation guided by faith (virtue and wisdom-oriented language is implicit rather than explicit in every line), which aligns with classical aims. However, the public-facing articulation of virtue/wisdom telos as core, explicit classical vocabulary is not as direct as the strongest Classical models. Hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school is described as a Private, Classical Christian School, with mention of a Classical framework and a K–8 structure that includes Latin in early grades and a plan to add high school. This signals some classical curricular elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric in a classical framework; Latin in K–8). - Text indicates growth toward in-seat high school and alignment with classical Christian options, signaling a long-term commitment to classical curricular structure. - Public materials emphasize a classical identity rather than a piecemeal modern “social studies-first” framing; the presence of Latin and a classical framing supports the category’s core elements.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric (classical trivium components) referenced via the broader Classical Christian framing; Latin (in K–8) appears in the materials. Great Books / Great Conversation is not explicitly stated in public copy. - Negative keywords: not obviously present (no strong shift toward purely social studies-first framing; no explicit “project-based learning first” signals in public copy). However, Great Books / Great Conversation and universal Great Books inclusion are not explicitly asserted.

Why this rating - The school shows clear classical curricular markers (grammar/logic/rhetoric framing; Latin; private classical Christian branding) but does not publicly advertise a full Great Books / Great Conversation program, nor explicit articulation of the daily discipline of scholé or a fully sequenced Trivium/Quadrivium curriculum. This justifies SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials do not present explicit, recurring references to Socratic seminars, scholé, or a heavy emphasis on Socratic dialogue, narration, chanting, or regular memory work as a public hallmark of pedagogy. The content focuses more on mission, community, and structural/classical branding than on detailed teaching methods. - When pedagogy is described, it centers on program evolution (e.g., in-seat high school) and community alignment, rather than an explicit pedagogy framework (e.g., the classical methods enumerated in the Classical School lexicon). - Some lower-level elements (Latin offerings, a classical identity) imply certain classical methods, but explicit pedagogy practices (narration, chanting, reformulated seminars) are not clearly documented in public copy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: none of the core pedagogy indicators (Socratic seminar, narration/recitation/chanting, scholé days, memory work, etc.) are explicitly named in public copy. Some hints at traditional education practices exist, but not the explicit pedagogical lexicon. - Negative signals: absence of explicit classical pedagogy terms; lack of a clear, public statement about Socratic/Scholé-based methods, seminars, or ritualized memory work.

Why this rating - Without explicit public articulation of the classical pedagogy (as defined by the six-element framework), Element 4 lands as NOT CLASSICAL despite a classical branding and some infrastructure elements. The explicit pedagogy evidence necessary to classify as CLASSICAL is not present in the accessible public materials.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school references a faculty structure with defined roles (head of school, multiple grade-level teachers) and a dan of small-class pedagogy (target class sizes of 10–13). This aligns with a traditional, virtuous-teacher model often associated with classical schools. - Public content portrays a staff-and-teacher-centric environment, with multiple teachers across K–8 and plans for expanding staff as enrollment grows, suggesting a living curriculum through faculty.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers and mentors; living curriculum; faculty of friends; collegial culture (these terms align with the classical faculty archetype). Evidence in the materials points to teachers as core agents of formation and living exemplars. - Negative keywords: not evident in public copy (no explicit “facilitator” or non-classical staff language; no signals of purely information-transfer orientation in faculty description).

Why this rating - The materials depict a traditional, formation-oriented faculty culture with defined leadership and a view of teachers as living curriculum. This aligns with classical expectations for the faculty category.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly frames parents as primary educators and partners in education, citing biblical mandates and a shared mission with families. This is a central, explicit element highlighting classical community formation. - The Inside Parents program invites parental immersion in classrooms, fostering parent formation and family involvement; they publicly welcome parental engagement and visits. This demonstrates a robust, engaged parent community. - Public materials emphasize community events, fellowship activities (e.g., donuts with dad, muffins with mom, crafting days), and family-focused programming that reinforce a cultivated classical community.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental primacy, parent formation, reading groups/book studies, open campus/visits, family liturgical rhythm cues (e.g., liturgical-ish calendar integration in community life). - Negative keywords: not evident in public copy (no consumer-employee dichotomy; no minimal parent involvement signals). The site emphasizes active parental engagement.

Why this rating - The Parents & Community category clearly aligns with classical expectations of strong parental partnership, parental formation opportunities, and an open-door approach to parenting involvement.

This marks CLASSICAL in this category.

Aggregate assessment - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 5: CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- Make explicit Great Books / Great Conversation elements a formal part of the curriculum and public messaging. Publicly articulate a Great Books trajectory or reading lists and a daily or yearly structure that reflects the Great Conversation, including references to canonical works. This would move Element 3 toward CLASSICAL and reinforce Element 2's formation narrative. (Supportive sources on Great Books/great conversation and associated pedagogy exist in the classical education lexicon.)
- Explicitly publish a formal pedagogy framework that includes Socratic seminars, scholé/restful learning, narration/recitation, and memory work as concrete teaching methods across appropriate grade bands. This would push Element 4 from NOT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL.
- Elevate and publicize a clearly defined Trivium/Quadrivium sequence, with explicit grammar-logic-rhetoric progression and a visible timeline for Latin and classical studies across grades. This would bolster Element 3 and Element 4 as well.
- Grow and showcase teacher-professional development around the classical living-curriculum model (e.g., professional development grounded in virtuous-teaching models and a well-documented portrait of the teacher as model of virtue). This would strengthen Element 5 and reinforce the overall CLASSICAL posture.
- Deepen explicit integration of the Great Conversation within the Great Books framework (including explicit references to truth, goodness, and beauty as real teloi in curriculum design and assessment). This would push Element 2 and Element 3 toward CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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